

module-08-yoga - Darshana (60-min workshop)

IKS Curriculum - senior band

Module 8 — Yoga and the Body (Darśana)

Sanskrit: *Yoga* · **Band:** Senior (9-12) · **Duration:** 60 min · **Path:** Darśana (Workshop)

Patañjali's eight limbs and safe āsana practice.

Darśana note. This workshop condenses Module 8's full 10-day arc into one hour. For the deeper version — daily lesson plans, quizzes, assessments, slide decks — switch to [Adhyayana](#) (the Full Course path).

Opening hook · 5 min

Project Patañjali's Yogasūtra (~200 BCE-200 CE). 196 sūtras. Project the Aṣṭāṅga (eight-limbs) chapter — *Sādhana-pāda*, sūtras 28-29. “*Modern global yoga = āsana + prāṇāyāma. Two of eight limbs. Today we see the full architecture.*”

Core idea · 15 min

Patañjali's Aṣṭāṅga Yoga — Yogasūtra (c. 200 BCE-200 CE).

1. **Yamas** (Sūtra 2.30): *ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, aparigraha*. Universal ethics.
2. **Niyamas** (Sūtra 2.32): *śauca, santoṣa, tapas, svādhyāya, īśvarapraṇidhāna*. Personal observances.
3. **Āsana** (Sūtra 2.46): *sthira-sukham āsanam* — “steady and comfortable seat.” NOT primarily about flexibility.
4. **Prāṇāyāma** (Sūtra 2.49-53): breath regulation, modern parallel to autonomic-system entrainment. 5-8. **Pratyāhāra** → **Samādhi**: progressive meditative absorption.

Critical: Patañjali says āsana is “steady-comfortable seat” — for meditation. The modern flexibility-focused practice (e.g., Iyengar lineage) is a 20th-century reformation, not the original system. Honest framing matters.

Demonstration · 10 min

Source-text close read. Project Yogasūtra 2.46-48 (āsana definition). Compare with Iyengar's *Light on Yoga* (1966) introduction. Discussion: what stayed same? What evolved?

Source moment · 5 min

Direct verse. Yogasūtra 1.2:

yogaḥ citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ

“Yoga is the cessation of the modifications of the mind-stuff.”

The entire eight-limb scaffolding is methodology for ONE goal: the *citta-vṛtti-nirodha*. Modern wellness-yoga has largely lost this framing.

Hands-on activity · 15 min

Compare three yoga traditions. Pairs research one: Patañjali Yogasūtra, Bhagavad Gītā ch. 6 (Dhyāna-Yoga), and the Haṭha Yoga Pradīpikā (~15th c. CE). Compare on: scope of practice, theological framing, treatment of the body.

Reflection + take-home · 10 min

“Yoga has been globalised, adapted, and commercialised since ~1960. What’s preserved? What’s lost? What’s added that wasn’t in the original?”

Go deeper into Adhyayana

The 10 days you’re skipping if you only do this workshop:

- **Day 01** — Yoga in your life — what is it really?
- **Day 02** — Yamas — five ethical restraints
- **Day 03** — Niyamas — five personal observances
- **Day 04** — Āsana — what Patañjali actually said
- **Day 05** — Prāṇāyāma — breath physiology
- **Day 06** — Pratyāhāra and Dhāraṇā — turning inward, focusing
- **Day 07** — Dhyāna — meditation as method
- **Day 08** — Samādhi — the goal
- **Day 09** — Modern yoga — what changed, what stayed
- **Day 10** — Personal practice plan + share

→ [Open the Adhyayana track for this module](#) to access all 10 days, the 4-audience PDFs, the slide deck, the quizzes, and the project rubric.